

Minerals of North America

Important Minerals in North America

Mineral	Area
Iron Ore	Canadian shield, Great Lake region, Appalachian Highlands, central Alabama, Minnesota's
Copper	Great lakes, Arizona, Utah, New Mexico, Nevada, Montana and Rockies mountains, Ontario, British Columbia
Silver	Nevada, Utah, British Columbia, Ontario, Quebec.
Gold	Canada –Ontario, Quebec USA – California, Colorado, Utah, Nevado.
Coal	Appalachians, Pennsylvania, Ohio,Alabama,Alberta and Columbia.
Petroleum	USA – Alaska to Texas Canada, Mexico
Oil and Natural Gas	Central low lands, Gulf coast Rockies, Appalachian, Alaska

Industries

North America has plenty of resources and is needed for industrial development. Industries are highly concentrated in the north eastern part of the continent because of large minerals deposits like coal, iron ore etc., and good transportation network like roads, railways and canals. The United States is one of the most industrialized countries in the world. Industries contribute about 25% of Gross National Product. The United State ranks first in Iron and Steel industry. They use the latest technology in developing their industries.

Major industries in North America

1. Iron and Steel Industry

The North American continent is the world's most important Iron and Steel industrial centre. Iron and Steel industries require Iron Ore, Coal and transportation. The important centres of the Iron and Steel industries in North America are Pittsburgh, Chicago and Birmingham in the United States and Hamilton in Canada.

2. Heavy Engineering Industries

Industries which require heavy and bulky raw materials using enormous amounts of power, involvement of huge investment and large transport costs are called heavy Engineering industries. These industries depend heavily on the Iron and Steel industry. The important Heavy Industries are automobile industries, aircraft industries, ship building industries, Railway Wagon industries and farm equipment industries. The USA is the largest producer of automobiles. The important Centres of heavy engineering industries are Detroit, Chicago, Buffalo, Indianapolis, Los Angeles, Saint Louis, Philadelphia, New York, Baltimore, and Atlanta in USA and Windsor in Canada.

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